

Rating manual

Observer-rated user behavior in human-robot interaction dialogs

1. Purpose of the rating task

This rating task assesses the **human user's observable conversational behavior** in short human-robot interaction dialogs. Raters should evaluate how the user participates in the conversation based only on the transcript. The goal is not to judge the robot, the topic, or the rater's personal impression of the robot, but to assess what the human user visibly says, asks, reveals, and expresses during the dialog.

2. Unit of analysis

Each complete dialog is one rating unit. Read the whole dialog before rating. Some dimensions depend on the overall pattern of the user's behavior rather than on one isolated turn.

3. General rating rules

- Rate only the **human user's behavior**. Do not directly evaluate the robot's answer quality, intelligence, appearance, or personality.
- Base your ratings only on what is visible in the transcript. Do not infer hidden emotions, intentions, or personality traits beyond what the user expresses.
- Transcription errors should be dealt with as leniently as possible; that is, if a statement can still be understood, the transcription errors should not be included in the evaluation. If the content is incomprehensible, the transcript will receive a low rating.
- Use the full 1–5 scale. Score 3 is neutral, meaning the behavior is neither clearly low nor clearly high, or the evidence is mixed, basic, or unclear.
- Do not automatically assign 3 when unsure. If the transcript clearly shows low or high evidence for a dimension, use the appropriate lower or higher score.
- For short dialogs, rate the quality of the available user contribution. Do not automatically give a low score only because the dialog is short, unless the shortness reflects minimal, passive, or disengaged user behavior.
- The anchor examples are illustrative. Raters should score the whole dialog, not only isolated phrases.

4. Per-dimension rating scales

Dimensions at a glance:

1. User engagement / enjoyment
2. User self-disclosure

3. User topical alignment
4. User elaboration / informativeness
5. User initiative / active contribution
6. User politeness
7. User frustration / dissatisfaction
8. Overall user-side interaction quality

Dimension 1: User engagement / enjoyment		
Question:		To what extent does the user appear engaged, interested, and motivated to keep the conversation going?
Definition:		User engagement / enjoyment refers to how involved, interested, and motivated the human user appears to be during the conversation.
Rating scale & anchor examples:		
1	Disengaged	"I don't want to talk to you anymore."
2	Low engagement	"No, thank you."
3	Neutral engagement	"I want to talk about watches."
4	Engaged	"I would like to know a good camping spot for photography lovers."
5	Highly engaged	"I would like to talk about watches. Why do some people prefer sport watches, while others prefer serious watches with no additional functions?"